

Artificial Intelligence I CSC 114

SYLLABUS 2026SU



Course Information

Artificial Intelligence I

Information Technology I CSC 114 1001

Meeting Location: ATC, ATC 115, 115

**Meeting Time(s): 05/26/26 07/20/26 ATC 115 CLAS MW 10:00AM 10:50AM, 05/26/26
07/20/26 ATC 115 LAB MW 11:00AM 11:50AM M W, M W**

Delivery Method: TR

Class Begins: 2026-05-26 Class Ends: 2026-07-20

Class Hours: 2.00 | Lab Hours: 3.00 | Clinic Hours: 0.00 Credit Hours: 3.00

To Contact the Instructor

Mallory Milstead

Office Location: ATC-113H

Office Hours: Upon request only for Summer

Phone: 910-678-8572

Email: milsteam@faytechcc.edu

Andrew Norris

Office Location: ATC-113C

Office Hours: Upon request only for Summer

Phone: 910-486-3967

Email: norrisa@faytechcc.edu

Course Description

This course covers the study of intelligent agent design and rational decision making. Topics include goal-driven agents, search techniques, optimization, basic problem-solving methods, logic, knowledge-based agents, statistical and probabilistic reasoning, and the basics of machine learning. Upon completion,

students should be able to demonstrate artificial intelligence design concepts.

Course Prerequisites: Take CSC-113;

Course Outcomes

At the completion of this course, the student will have:

- Create a Custom Agent
- Been introduced to the basics of Deep Learning
- Learn and Apply AI Frameworks like Keras and Pytorch
- Learn the most commonly used AI algorithms such as classification and regression
- Understand and apply the Machine Learning workflow to train a small model
- Learn the basics of Computer Vision
- Apply Natural Language Processing algorithms
- Become familiar with how to use and optimize Large Language Models

Required Textbook and Companion Site

Information about the [FTCC Bookstore \(opens in new window\)](https://bookstore.faytechcc.edu/) [URL: <https://bookstore.faytechcc.edu/>] is available on the FTCC college website. To make textbook purchases online, select “Textbook Lookup” on the FTCC Bookstore web page.

Title: Deep Learning with Python
ISBN: 9781633436589
Authors: François Chollet and Matthew Watson
Publisher: Manning Publications Co.
Publication Date: 2026
Edition: 3rd Edition

Other Required Materials/Software

- The recommended browsers are Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, and Safari in the most updated version.

- Microsoft Office 365 (<https://www.faytechcc.edu/its/students/>) (opens in a new window) is available to currently enrolled students at FTCC. The Microsoft Office 365 app is available for download on up to five (5) computers and/or mobile devices. Direct link to download Office 365: <https://login.microsoftonline.com> (opens in new window).
- Username: FTCCSelf-Servicelogin@student.faytechcc.edu (example: smithj6666@student.faytechcc.edu). Password: Active Directory (Self-Service) password (if you have not created an Active Directory password, you will need to do this first).
- Blackboard Technical Support is available at any time, seven days a week by calling 1-888-829-9660. Assistance on specific trouble-shooting topics are found at Blackboard Help Online (opens in new window) [URL: <https://help.blackboard.com/Learn/Student>].
- Canvas Technical Support is available at any time, seven days a week by calling 1-866-645-6305 or by using the Help menu within your Canvas course. In the Help section, you can live chat with support, view training videos, or click “Report a Problem” to submit a support ticket. If you are unable to log into Canvas and cannot access the “Report a Problem” feature, please contact the FTCC Help Desk for login assistance only at help@faytechcc.edu or call 910-678-8473.
 - Additional resources for students new to Canvas are available at: Canvas Student Getting Started Guide (opens in new window) [URL: <https://community.canvaslms.com/t5/Student-Guide/Student-Getting-Started-Resources/ta-p/579371>].

If you have your own laptop, you should bring it to every class meeting. It is NOT required for the course, but will be helpful to you.

Pre-Census Attendance and Active Participation

Pre-Census Attendance

The College believes that when students participate in class regularly, they are demonstrating responsibility and commitment to their education. While the College does not have an institutional attendance policy, taking attendance is required through the census date of the class. The Office of Veteran Affairs requires notification when VA students stop attending class, and instructors are responsible for reporting these dates.

Students enrolled in any course, regardless of delivery method, must be in attendance, or receive a participation grade and be recorded as present, or

actively participating at least one time on or before the census date of the course (the first 10% of the term). Students who have not attended or actively participated at least once by the census date will be dropped by the instructor as a "No Show." For fully online courses, a student must complete a graded assignment on or before the census date. For face-to-face and hybrid courses, a student must be physically present in the class and complete any required online assignments on or before the census date. Fayetteville Technical Community College is committed to student success, retention, and progression.

As required by law, students are allowed two days of excused absences each academic year for religious observances. Students must notify instructors in writing in advance of expected religious absences.

Active Participation

Following the census date of the course, students are expected to actively participate in all scheduled courses.

Students who do not actively participate may be withdrawn from their courses by the instructor. Active participation includes, but is not limited to the following academically related activities:

- Attending a synchronous class, lecture, recitation, or field or laboratory activity, physically or online, where there is an opportunity for interaction between the instructor and students;
- Submitting an academic assignment;
- Taking or submitting an assessment, test, exam, or quiz;
- Participating in an interactive tutorial, webinar, or other interactive computer-assisted instruction;
- Participating in a study group or group project, whether in person or online, that is assigned by the instructor;
- Participating in a discussion in the class or posting in a discussion forum online regarding academic matters;
- Interacting with or emailing an instructor about the academic subject studied in the course.

Grading Scale

Numerical Grade	Letter Grade Equivalent	Equivalent Grade Point
90 - 100	A - Excellent	4 grade points per credit hour
80 - 89	B - Good	3 grade points per credit hour
70 - 79	C - Average	2 grade points per credit hour
60 - 69	D - Below Average	1 grade point per credit hour
0 - 59	F - Failure	0 grade point

Course Requirements/Methods of Evaluation

Categories	Weight

Departmental Policies

Late Policy (for this course):

Assignments may be turned in after the due date, with a late penalty, for two (2) weeks.

However, no late assignments will be accepted after 7/19/2026, the day before the final class. (This is to prevent us having to grade late assignments and final projects at the same time.)

Make-Up Policy

Late academic work submission procedures are as follows:

- 1. Academic assignments and projects are due by the scheduled/published dates.**
- 2. In general, there is a 10-point penalty for each business day that an assignment or project is late. For example, if the maximum number of points you can earn on an assignment or project is 100 points, 10 points will be deducted from your grade for each business day your assignment or project is late. If your assignment is due on Tuesday and you submit on Wednesday, the highest possible grade you can earn is a 90. With each additional day late, there is a 10-point reduction in the grade for this example. Assignments may be submitted no more than one week late without prior approval from your instructor.**
- 3. No late work will be accepted after the 90 percent date of the term without an incomplete grade approval from your instructor.**

4. Certain course activities may not be eligible for late submission after the conclusion of the week, module, or unit. These include, but are not limited to, discussion boards, quizzes, labs, and exams.
5. We know that extenuating circumstances can sometime interfere with timely submission of your work. Be sure to tell your instructor right away if you are going to be late with a submission.
6. Extenuating circumstances include, but are not limited to, personal/family member hospitalization, family member death, a severe weather event, a natural disaster, and an active military situation that prevents timely submission of work. Computer-related issues, internet connectivity, and account blocks are generally not considered extenuating circumstances.
7. You may request an extension or alternative arrangement, preferably prior to the due date, but your request does not automatically result in a waiver of the due date or of the penalties for late submissions. Your instructor may also require you to provide documentation of the reason. If your instructor determines that an extension is warranted, they will provide you with the expectations for your submission.

Academic Integrity - Plagiarism

All FTCC students are expected to comply with the FTCC Student Code of Conduct, which requires students to practice academic integrity in college courses. Students demonstrate academic integrity by being honest and responsible in all scholarship and scholarly activity. Students are not permitted to engage in any form of academic dishonesty, including the following offenses:

1. Obtaining test information, research papers, notes, and other academic material without authorization.
2. Receiving or giving help on tests, projects, or other assignments submitted for a grade unless specifically authorized by the instructor.
3. Plagiarism, which is taking credit for another's ideas or works as if they were your own. Examples of plagiarism include: submitting the work generated by an artificial intelligence (AI) tool (Chat GPT), allowing another individual to complete any of your course work, copying another individual's work and presenting any of these as your own.

Penalties for plagiarism and cheating that may be imposed by the instructor include, but are not limited to, the following:

1. Rewriting the assignment or resubmitting the activity.
2. Receiving a “0” on the assignment or activity.
3. Failing the course in which the assignment or activity was submitted

Penalties for plagiarism and cheating that may be recommended include, but are not limited to, the following:

1. Academic probation.
2. Academic suspension.
3. Expulsion from the college.

Additional information regarding academic integrity can be found in the Student Code of Conduct section of the [Student Handbook](#) (opens in new window).

Institutional Statement

To ensure a successful start and finish to college, all FTCC students should become knowledgeable of important policies, practices, and procedures and aware of where that information is located in the FTCC Catalog, FTCC Student Handbook, and FTCC Student Code of Conduct. Students should also become familiar with the semester information concerning key dates, course offerings, and schedules, etc., listed in the curriculum semester tabloids. All documents can also be found on the [FTCC website](#) (opens in new window) [URL: <https://www.faytechcc.edu/>].

Course Concerns

Students have the right to inquire about academic issues or other concerns related to the classroom environment. Inquiries should be directed to the following persons in the following order:

Course Instructor:

Name: Mallory Milstead

Phone:

Email: milsteam@faytechcc.edu

Department Chair:

Name: David Teter

Phone: 910-678-9844

Email: teterd@faytechcc.edu

Dean:

Name: Dwyane Campbell

Phone: 910-678-7353

Email: campbeldw@faytechcc.edu

Americans with Disabilities Act

FTCC facilitates the implementation of reasonable academic accommodations, including resources and services for students with disabilities, chronic medical conditions, a temporary disability, or other health related conditions resulting in difficulties with accessing learning opportunities. All accommodations are coordinated through the Disability Support Services Office located in the Tony Rand Student Center, Room 127, or call 910-678-8559. Please contact the [Disability Support Services](https://www.faytechcc.edu/campus-life/accessibility/) office (opens in new window) [URL: <https://www.faytechcc.edu/campus-life/accessibility/>] as early in the semester as possible.

Title VI, Title VII, and Title IX

FTCC does not practice or condone discrimination in any form against students, employees, or applicants on the grounds of race, color, national origin, religion, sex, age, disability, or political affiliation. FTCC commits itself to positive action to secure equal opportunity regardless of those characteristics.

FTCC supports the protection available to members of its community under all

applicable federal laws, including Title VI and VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and 1991, Title IX of the Educational Amendments of 1972, Sections 799A and 845 of the Public Health Service Act, the Equal Pay and Age Discrimination Acts, the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, and Executive Order 11375. For more information, please visit the [Title IX and Equal Opportunity](https://www.faytechcc.edu/title-ix-equal-opportunity/) (opens in new window) [URL: <https://www.faytechcc.edu/title-ix-equal-opportunity/>] page on the FTCC website.

Syllabus/Schedule Changes

This syllabus may be changed at the instructor's discretion, with proper notification to students. Any changes will be promptly noted in Announcements and emailed to the student's FTCC student email account.

Outline of Instruction

Module	Topic	Activities and Assignments	Due Dates

Class Schedule

Due Date	Name	Type	Points
	Cool AI Stuff that We Find	Discussion	0
	Create a Claude Project (Assess)	Assignment	0
	Create a Custom Agent (Apply)	Assignment	

Due Date	Name	Type	Points
5/30/26	Module 0 Quiz	Quiz	100
6/7/26	Create a "Claude Project" Agent (Apply)	Assignment	100
6/7/26	Create a Claude Project (Practice)	Assignment	50